MERROWFIELD DIGITAL

Sensitive Data Handling Standard

Document Standard 02 | Rev 2 | Effective 5 January 2026 | Owner: Office of the Data Protection Officer | Review cycle: 24 months

1. Purpose

Three categories of personal data carry the highest risk to the people they describe and the strictest handling at Merrowfield Digital. This standard says what they are, how they are handled, and what an incident involving them demands of the desk.

2. What counts as sensitive

Government ID, health data and children's accounts are sensitive data. On the incident record they are the government_id_flag, the health_data_flag and the child_accounts_flag. An incident involving any one of them is a sensitive-data incident.

3. The extra review

Every sensitive-data incident receives an extra review by the Data Protection Officer before any decision: which records are affected, whose, whether the people can be identified from what was taken, and what harm could follow. The review is done in addition to containment, not instead of it.

4. The effort multiplier

Because of the extra review, the effort needed to establish the facts of a sensitive-data incident is planned higher than for an otherwise identical incident.

The containment effort estimate is multiplied by 1.5 when any sensitive data is involved.

The multiplier is applied once, however many sensitive categories are involved. The estimate it multiplies is the baseline for the incident: the effort expected as if no sensitive-data review were needed.

The multiplied estimate is the one compared with the hours available before the earliest deadline (Plan 01, section 8).

5. Handling rules

- Sensitive data is stored only in systems approved for it, encrypted at rest, with access logged and reviewed monthly.
- Government ID documents collected for seller verification are deleted once verification is complete, unless the law requires them to be kept.
- Health data is never used for marketing and never leaves the order systems in an extract.
- Children's accounts are flagged at sign-up, and their data is excluded from analytics exports.
- An analyst handling a sensitive-data incident shares extracts only through the case folder, never by email.